

DORA Metrics - DevOps KPIs

Applicable Roles: DEVELOPER, DEVOPS, PM

Overview

DORA (DevOps Research and Assessment) metrics are the industry standard for measuring DevOps performance. Four key metrics that predict organizational performance.

1. Deployment Frequency

How often an organization deploys to production.

Elite: Multiple deploys per day

High: Once per week to once per month

Medium: Once per month to once every 6 months

Low: Fewer than once every 6 months

Target: Daily or more frequent deployments

2. Lead Time for Changes

Time from code commit to running in production.

Elite: Less than 1 hour

High: 1 day to 1 week

Medium: 1 week to 1 month

Low: More than 6 months

Target: Less than 24 hours

3. Change Failure Rate

Percentage of deployments causing a failure in production.

Elite: 0-5%

High: 5-15%

Medium: 15-30%

Low: >30%

Target: Less than 10%

4. Time to Restore Service

Time from incident detection to full recovery.

Elite: Less than 1 hour

High: Less than 1 day

Medium: 1 day to 1 week

Low: More than 6 months

Target: Less than 4 hours

Improvement Strategies

- Automate deployment pipeline
- Implement feature flags
- Use canary deployments
- Improve monitoring/alerting
- Conduct blameless post-mortems
- Invest in CI/CD infrastructure